

# Slackware Linux

## What's the Point?



Is Slackware for you? In this article, the author takes a good hard look at the pros and cons of using Slackware.

Slackware Linux is probably known to every Linux user across the world, since it's the oldest maintained GNU/Linux distribution—a month older than Debian GNU/Linux. Slackware Linux was created by Patrick Volkerding, who is the main developer and chief decision-maker of the project. There have been other contributors lending him a hand too, like David Cantrell and Chris Lumens.

### 13.0 -> 13.1

Recalling the release of Slackware 13.0 last year on the 25th of August, I was excited, as always, and eager to ride the latest Slack wave. KDE 4.2.4 was included in the release; this was part of the excitement, since Slackware developers have a conservative 'proven-stable' approach when it comes to pushing upgrades—

it was their first leap from KDE3 to KDE4. However, I was extremely disappointed; I can assure you it was neither a smooth ride, nor the best decision ever. From the annoyance of Akonadi greetings, to frequent KDE crashes, my patience was wearing thin, till I felt I had had enough of KDE. Another serious bug was in K3B, the default CD/DVD burning application in KDE. There were numerous reports about K3B freezing after completing more than 90 per cent of the burn process, and I personally faced this issue, with a few of my DVDs destroyed. XFCE and other components were in perfect shape, but KDE was just unusable.

However, things have changed since then. KDE has now been updated to 4.4.3 Software Compilation; K3B works fine in this version. Overall, this time around it felt Slackware lived up to its reputation of providing a stable